

Chapter 99-2

//

After Liang Shi finished her shower, she changed into pajamas. She casually towed her hair dry, leaving it half-damp and uncombed.

Curly hair was more troublesome to manage, so she wasn't in the habit of combing it right after washing. She would wait until it was about seventy percent dry before combing.

But the moment she opened the door, she saw three little kids standing in a neat row at the entrance, all tilting their heads up to look at her with sparkling eyes.

Most crucially—they weren't wearing clothes.

Liang Shi was startled and her expression immediately changed. "What are you all doing? Go back to bed and lie down."

"Auntie." Ling Dang said coquettishly. "You're back! They didn't hit you, did they?"

"No." Liang Shi said while pulling them back to the room. "You're not even wearing clothes. You'll catch a cold."

No sooner had she finished speaking than Rainbow sneezed.

"See?" Liang Shi quickly carried her back to bed and covered her with the blanket. "How long were you standing at the door?"

"Don't know." Ling Dang was the easiest to get information out of. "We've been standing there since you started singing."

Liang Shi: "....."

When had she been singing?

She didn't even know herself.

Anyway, these kids' bodies were all chilly. One touch and you could tell they had been standing there for a long time.

After tucking them all under the blankets, Sheng Yu leaned close to Rainbow and lowered her voice to say, "See, people who don't exercise regularly have weak bodies. We're all fine, but you're the one sneezing!"

Rainbow pursed her lips. "That's not true."

Sheng Yu said, "It is true. Are you going to come play with me after class from now on?"

Rainbow firmly refused. "No."

"Then keep getting sick! Nyeh nyeh~" Before she even finished speaking, her nose twitched and she immediately covered her mouth and sneezed. Even so, Rainbow sitting beside her was caught in the crossfire. But Rainbow calmly wiped her face. "Running around randomly isn't exercise. Your immune system is pretty weak too."

Sheng Yu rubbed her nose, like a proud little peacock. "Hmph! What do you know? My sister said: one sneeze means someone's thinking of you, two means someone's cursing you, three means you have a cold.¹ I only sneezed once, so that means someone is... achoo!"

The proud little peacock hadn't even finished showing off before she sneezed again.

Ling Dang, nestled in Liang Shi's arms, laughed and couldn't help saying, "Sheng Yu, does that mean someone's cursing you now?"

"Yeah." Sheng Yu kicked Rainbow under the blanket. "I said that about Zhou Caihong, so she's definitely cursing me in her heart... achoo!"

.....

Rainbow moved farther away from her. "I didn't curse you. Your immune system is weak. You caught a cold."

Sheng Yu rubbed her nose, the tip all red, and huffed at Rainbow. "You definitely infected me."

Rainbow: "....."

She really wanted to say that colds couldn't spread that fast.

But a few seconds later, Rainbow said very seriously, "You said it yourself—one sneeze means someone's thinking of you, two means cursing, three means a cold. I only sneezed once, so someone's thinking of me. But you sneezed three times, so you have a cold. I don't."

Sheng Yu: "?"

Awoo.

That detestable Rainbow.

Rainbow, having finally won a verbal victory, secretly smiled and raised an eyebrow at Liang Shi.

Liang Shi secretly gave her a thumbs up.

Meanwhile, Ling Dang nestled in Liang Shi's arms and asked her what happened last night. Did those people bully her?

Liang Shi answered patiently, "The police uncles protect good people. Auntie just made a small mistake, and after apologizing, they let me go. How could I have been bullied?"

Ling Dang was still conflicted. She apologized guiltily, her voice muffled. "Auntie, I'm sorry. If it weren't for me, you wouldn't have gone to beat someone up."

"Oh, come on." Liang Shi looked at her already reddening eyes and reached out to pinch her cheek. "Why is our little Ling Dang being so sentimental now? It was just a small thing. Hitting people is wrong, but it also depends on who you're hitting."

Seeing that Ling Dang still couldn't cheer up, Liang Shi asked Sheng Yu, who was still trying to battle Rainbow for three hundred rounds, "Sheng Yu, would you say I looked cool when I hit that person yesterday?"

"Super cool!" Sheng Yu immediately got excited. She gestured while talking. "Last night, jiejie just knocked that ugly auntie right down. When she grabbed her hand, that auntie's hand was like a chicken claw, like this..."

She imitated it perfectly, then scoffed. Seeing Ling Dang still looking aggrieved while nestled in Liang Shi's arms, looking like she was about to cry, she couldn't help poking her forehead. "Liang Wenxuan, you're so annoying."²

Liang Shi: "?"

Where did this random accent come from?

"That person cursed at us." Sheng Yu stood on the bed, looking just like a knight about to go conquer the world—except this knight's hair wasn't cooperating and kept getting in her mouth. She spat it out and threw that strand of hair behind her ear. "To be able to say such horrible things to cute kids like us—doesn't she have children of her own?! If my mom and uncle had heard it yesterday, they would have beaten her to death!"

"But even without mom and uncle, my two jiejies could have beaten her to death!" Sheng Yu said matter-of-factly. "People who curse at children deserve to be hit. But Liang-jiejie hit someone, so being taken away by the police uncles is also deserved. When you do something wrong, there are consequences."

After Sheng Yu finished, she kicked Rainbow. "Applause!"

Rainbow: "....."

Ling Dang listened in a daze, but she didn't understand. "What does 'annoying' mean?"²

Sheng Yu: "It means you're being wishy-washy."

Ling Dang: "....."

Liang Shi was amused by Sheng Yu's quirky antics, holding back her laughter until her stomach hurt.

One second the "Queen Sheng" was giving a passionate speech, and the next she was scooped up by Liang Shi and tossed into the blanket, wrapped up into a ball.

"You really aren't afraid of catching a cold." Liang Shi pinched her cheek. "I'll make you some ginger sugar water to drink later. Don't go running around without clothes on. It's been cold these past few days."

Sheng Yu stuck her tongue out at her, rolled around next to her, and called out to Rainbow who seemed isolated from the world. "Come on, Zhou Caihong, let's roll onto Liang-jiejie together and fill up her arms."

Rainbow was a bit cautious, not used to Sheng Yu's wild way of acting spoiled.

Seeing her like this, Liang Shi immediately waved to her. "Rainbow, come here quickly. I'll hold you, not Sheng Yu."

Sheng Yu scrambled over with flailing limbs. "No way."

Footnotes:

¹ This is a Chinese folk belief about sneezing. The full saying goes: "一想二罵三感冒" (yī xiǎng èr mà sān gǎnmào) - one sneeze means someone is thinking of you, two sneezes means someone is cursing/badmouthing you, and three sneezes means you have a cold.

² "機車" (jīchē): This is Taiwanese slang that literally means "motorcycle" but is used to describe someone who is annoying, troublesome, or being difficult. It's a distinctly Taiwanese expression, which is why Liang Shi was puzzled about where the accent came from.